

Banality points may be thought of as contamination, as something of the outside world clinging stubbornly to the changeling and slowly affecting her mind. When a changeling's Banality pool exceeds her Glamour rating, she begins to suffer from the Mists, her memory slipping away by drips and drabs. To recall anything more clearly than specified on the Mists chart (below), the player must roll Glamour against a difficulty equal to her Banality rating.

Long-term exposure to a concentrated source of extreme Banality (such as a person or an object with a high Banality rating) results in the changeling gaining a point of temporary Banality. This threshold is typically reached after a scene of distinctly uncomfortable interaction — most changelings naturally do their best to avoid such individuals and things, but there are few places outside the Dreaming where one can hide from Banality. Ultimately, the amount of exposure necessary to cause the changeling to gain Banality is left to Storyteller discretion, but she should be quite clear about when that threshold is about to be crossed. Grumps do not gain Banality in this manner.

## TRIGGERS

Banality is an all-pervasive force, but at times it redoubles itself, aggressively seeking the weak points within a changeling's soul and doing its best to push its way in. Rather than simply gaining a temporary point of Banality from ambient exposure, this is an immediate and brutal invasion of the changeling's faerie self. These surges of Banality are called triggers, and all Kithain suffer from them. When a character experiences a Banality trigger, the player rolls Glamour (difficulty 8). If the roll fails, the character gains a point of Banality. If the roll is a botch, the character gains a point of Banality for every 1 rolled.

The following triggers are common to all changelings, a result of their very natures at conflict with Banality itself.

- ☉ Invoking the Autumn to resist a cantrip or chimerical effect.
- ☉ Failing to overcome a target's Banality while enchanting them (this does not apply to childlings).
- ☉ Wilfully destroying a Treasure or any other irreplaceable faerie artifact.
- ☉ Killing a changeling's chimerical self (wilders are immune to this trigger under most circumstances).
- ☉ Ending a changeling's mortal life.
- ☉ Killing one of the enchanted, a mortal Dreamer, or Kinain.
- ☉ Wielding cold iron.
- ☉ Ravaging or Rhapsodizing a mortal.
- ☉ Breaking an oath.

## ANTITHESIS

In addition, each Changeling has a personal trigger, a source of Banality unique to her that profoundly violates her very nature. This *antithesis* probably relates to the changeling's kith in some way, but it doesn't have to. While many acts could potentially qualify, Storytellers and players should come to agreement on individual antitheses. Some examples include:

- ☉ Interfering with the play of children.
- ☉ Breaking an object of great beauty (mundane or otherwise).

- ☉ Wearing a suit and tie on her mortal body.

- ☉ Giving someone a false compliment.

If all Banality were temporary, it would scarcely be the threat to the Kithain that it is. As described on p. 174, however, gaining more than 10 points of Banality results in the character's Banality rating increasing. The only way to remove Banality dots is through a great Quest that empowers her faerie soul to expunge one of these slivers of Banality, though such Quests are strenuous and difficult indeed, uncommonly attempted and rarely successful. Still, hope remains. Details on Quests may be found on p. 271.

## The Mists

The Mists, for all that changelings may curse them, are in fact a defense against Banality, though a cruel one. When the Mists rise, memory fades — this serves to cloak Glamour behind a veil that even Banality cannot penetrate. Most of the time, this serves to hide evidence of faerie magic from the eyes of mortals, as it slips from their minds mere moments after they witness it. Though Banality has thoroughly corrupted most mortals, those fortunate enough to have a lower Banality rating remember more than their higher-Banality comrades, though the memories still have a strange and dreamlike quality, not entirely real save to those with the very lowest of Banality ratings.

The Mists touch changelings as well, though, clouding and even stealing away their memories as Banality surges within them. The more Banality points a changeling has, the more the Mists touch her in her day-to-day life. The presence of other Kithain helps to ameliorate this effect, allowing the character to recall as though she were two steps lower on the Mists chart during any scene in which other changelings are present, as they serve as an anchor for her memories of Glamour and the chimerical.



## The Mists



| Banality Rating | Duration    | Effect           |
|-----------------|-------------|------------------|
| 0               | One Minute  | Perfect Recall   |
| 1               | One Hour    | Clarity          |
| 2               | Six Hours   | Partial Memory   |
| 3               | 12 Hours    | Disoriented      |
| 4               | One Day     | Uncertain Memory |
| 5               | Three Days  | Hazy Memory      |
| 6               | One Week    | Vivid Flashbacks |
| 7               | Two Weeks   | Dreamlike Memory |
| 8               | One Month   | Distant Dream    |
| 9               | Four Months | Denial           |
| 10              | N/A         | Complete Blank   |